GREY BANNER ALERT

mainroads WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	17th February 2026	**Time of Incident**	10:45 AM
Directorate / Region	RMO, Wheatbelt	**Main Roads or Contractor**	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Injury/ Illness	**EQSafe Incident Number**	56820
Actual Consequence	Moderate	**Potential Consequence**	Moderate

Incident Short Description	Quick-Cut Saw Strikes Worker in Face

Executive Summary

On the 17th February 2026, a Contractor Worker (Injured Person) and their colleagues were tasked to lay the sand-pad and install 450mm diameter Reinforced Concrete Pipes (RCP's) into an excavation at the Road Train Assembly Area in Northam. The team had laid and compacted the sand-pad and had installed 2 RCP's into the excavation.

To complete the installation, the final RCP (which was positioned on approx. 100mm of sand that was residual material from the sand pad) was required to be cut to the appropriate length. The IP measured the pipe and marked the cut location.

Following a discussion between the IP and a colleague in relation to the cutting task, the IP went to their Light Vehicle to retrieve the quick-cut saw, while their colleague bought the water truck to the location where the cutting activity would take place.

The IP conducted a visual inspection of the quick-cut saw and proceeded to connect the hose from the water truck to the quick-cut saw. The IP commenced cutting the RCP and had rolled the pipe twice to access the next section of the kerf.

The IP rolled the RCP one more time to access the area of the last cut. As the IP inserted the quick-cut saw blade to complete the final cut, the kerf closed on the blade, causing the quick-cut saw to kick upward and rotate backwards, with the force of the sudden movement pulling the saw from the IP's hand and toward their face.

While the blade was still in motion, the blade contacted the IP on the right side of their face, resulting in a laceration which extended from their nose to their lower lip.

Image: Photo of work area and RCP. Note the top of the pipe which is closed.

Contributing Factors

- The SWMS did not contain information to inform the Workers of the correct placement of the RCP to prevent pinching of the blade
- The work instruction was not updated on site to include the hazards and risks associated with cutting the RCP.
- The RCP was placed on 100mm of sand which was left on site from a previous task. The RCP was supported by the flange of the pipe at one end, and sand beneath the opposite end of the RCP. This led to a space existing between the centre of the pipe (where the cut was being placed) and the surface.
- Contractor SWMS did not cover the placement of the RCP on a suitable surface or in a secure position.
- Project specific and regional risk register did not contain information of controls for when RCP's are being cut at ground level.
- Management Systems - Prestart meeting form was used for multiple days (11th, 12th 13th, 15th, 16th and 17th February 2026). One form should be used per day to ensure that information communicated and assessed is applicable for the days task.
- Organisation – Due to resourcing issues, the Project Manager was required to take on Supervisor responsibilities.
  Also to note, the PM was required to maintain MoP truck movements throughout the life of the project.

Corrective Actions – All Main Roads and Contractors

- Review and update Safe Work Method Statements relating to RCP cutting using quick-cut saws to ensure all material being cut is secured in a manner to prevent the pipe pinching the saw blade.
- Update regional project risk registers to include hazards and controls associated with quick-cut saws, and identify RCP securing methods.

Distribution of Notice	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations